

1.1 Getting A Domain

The first step to hosting your Web site is choosing your domain name and getting it registered. Choosing the right name depends on a number of factors. If you are a business with an already established presence, it would make sense to use your company name. If you're promoting a particular product, it may be a better idea to use that product's name. If it's a personal Web site, you could use your own name... and so on. Some of the ground rules in choosing a domain name are:

- It shouldn't be too long
- It should be easy to remember
- It should not be easy to misspell the name

Like the site name, the last part of the domain name - which ends in .com, .net, .org, etc. - is also important. The choice of what domain extension to register your site under should also be driven by your target audience. Registering with a .com extension is the default consideration. Most people associate Web site addresses with the .com extension. So even if they've heard of your company



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